

» SPORTSTAR ACES INTERVIEW – 4X400 RELAY TEAM



AMOJ JACOB BELIEVES THAT HIS TEAMMATES ARE CAPABLE OF RUNNING A POTENTIAL TIME IN THE 2:58.00 RANGE, WHICH COULD HELP THEM SECURE A PODIUM FINISH IN PARIS

Being feted: The Men's 4x400 Relay team receives Sportsman of the year (Track and Field) award from P. T. Usha, President of Indian Olympic Association during the Sportstar ACES Awards 2024 in Mumbai. RITU RAJ KONWAR

NEED FOR SPEED IN OLYMPIC YEAR

The Indian men's 4x400m relay team is **optimistic about a podium finish** at the Paris Olympics.

Jonathan Selvaraj

jonathan.selvaraj@thehindu.co.in

In November 2023, the Indian men's 4x400m relay team assembled at the start of the national camp. Before their first training session, the national coach, Jason Dawson, addressed the team and shared his expectations for the upcoming season. "It's going to be a hell of a year. It's going to be nothing less than an actual war," Nihal William

recalls Dawson saying.

After a well-deserved break, the team returned to training and already had an idea of what was in store. The Indian relay squad won the *Sportsman of the Year (Track and Field)* award at the *Sportstar Aces Awards* in Mumbai after an incredible 2023 season, in which it won gold at the Asian Championships, broke the Asian record, and took fifth place at

the World Championships. The team, which included Muhammad Anas, Amoj Jacob, Muhammed Ajmal Variyathodi, Rajesh Ramesh, and reserve runners Mijo Kurian and William, then went on to win gold at the Asian Games in Hangzhou.

Reflecting on the season, William shares, "During the year, we all had aspirations of exploring different places at the season's end. Amoj and

